

Rafaela X. Solís (she/her)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game designer pursuing dual B.S. degrees in Game Design and Game Programming with a Project Management minor. Designs across three studio titles at Pentad Games, leading two, prototyping in Unity and Unreal Engine 5 (C++, Lua, C#) and directing the team that builds them. Placed 2nd internationally in the CurseForge Subnautica 2 Modding Contest (6,500+ mod downloads). Programming makes it possible to prototype firsthand and work fluently with engineers; production training means leading or supporting a team.

EDUCATION

Champlain College

Bachelor of Science in Game Design; Bachelor of Science in Game Programming
Project Management Minor. GPA: 3.90. Dean's List, all semesters.

Burlington, VT
Expected May 2028

Relevant Coursework: Level Design, Applied Ludology, Principles of Game Design, Game Technology I and II, Game Studio I, Games Testing Lab, Artificial Intelligence for Games, Game Architecture, Principles of Project Management

EXPERIENCE

Lead Developer (Lead Designer, Lead Programmer, Product Owner)

October 2024 – Present

Pentad Games (formerly Vellum Games)

- Lead design on Open Shift, a co-op cozy-horror storekeeping game entering beta, directing a 5–7 person team (up to 10) and driving community building and teaser launch
- Designed 50+ gameplay features across Open Shift, Scriptorium (Lead Designer), and Mega Market Mayhem (Designer, Engine Implementer), scoping each from concept to a playtested, implementable state
- Prototype in Unity 6 (C#) for weekly Agile/Scrum builds; Open Shift playtests found constant scares numbing, so paced them out
- Designed rune-drawing combat; messy runes misread in playtests, so retrained the CNN (TensorFlow, Keras) on player samples
- Author GDDs, VDDs, system diagrams, and level design mockups that align art, programming, and audio
- Built the studio's self-hosted AFFiNE suite: kanban tracking, art critique workflows, AI meeting notes, and nightly CI builds

Project Manager

October 2026 – Present

Leahy Center for Digital Forensics & Cybersecurity, Champlain College

Burlington, VT

- Restructure documentation, workflows, and meetings across the organization's teams while keeping each team's familiar setup

Producer

August 2024 – Present

Champlain College Academic Game Projects

- Produced 5+ multidisciplinary teams of 3–6 on weekly sprints, shipping every project on time across one-month to multi-year runs
- Rat Attack: too dark and not tense enough in playtests; added audio cues, faster rats, and spline-driven random-intent movement
- Mazetastic: playtests found colors too similar and spins hard to read, so raised palette contrast and added clear spin telegraphs
- On The Owl Keeper (educational game), cut full voice-acted dialogue to meet the deadline and redirected the sound designer to voice key story moments, preserving narrative impact

Food Handler (FOH/BOH)

August 2022 – May 2023

Bakery Lorraine

San Antonio, TX

- Stepped into team lead during peak hours in a high-volume kitchen, coordinating prep and preventing stock shortages

PROJECTS

Subnautica 2 Modding Contest, 2nd Place Internationally (CurseForge)

June 2026

- Designed and built Easy Third Person (C++, Lua, UE5), a third-person camera mod; won 2nd place internationally and \$650
- Reverse-engineered UE4SS for custom systems; added camera collision after playtesters saw the camera clip through walls
- Released Easy Third Person and The Gold Mod (6,000+ downloads; CurseForge banner), plus 3 Minecraft modpacks (560+)

Indie Game Development <https://solunabeeboo.itch.io/>

March 2020 – Present

- Designed and developed 12+ original games solo, owning concept, systems design, art, build, and release
- Created all original art, including hand-drawn sprites, 3D models, and textures

SKILLS

Design: Systems Design, Gameplay Design, Level Design, Technical Design, Narrative Design, Rapid Prototyping, Playtesting and Data Analysis, GDDs, VDDs, System Diagrams, UI/UX

Languages: C++, Lua, C#, Python, Java, HTML/CSS

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Lyra Framework), UEFN, Unity 6, UE4SS, Blueprints, Shaders, OpenGL

Production and Pipeline: Agile/Scrum, Jira, Confluence, Taiga, AFFiNE, Git, GitHub Actions, Subversion, Production Documentation

Art: Pixel Art, 3D Modeling, Blender, Aseprite, Photoshop, Illustrator, DaVinci Resolve

Playtesting: External playtests for Behaviour Interactive (Dead by Daylight, Blight: Survival)